PROPERTY MANAGEMENT SUITE

Alternate Brand Style Guide (PMS)

Alternate direction: premium, calm, operations-first design language.

Alternate Brand Style Guide (PMS)

0) Scope and intent

This is an **alternate visual direction** for PMS that stays compatible with existing logo assets and product trust signals, while shifting expression from “tech-forward utility” to “premium operational clarity.”

- Works with current `Branding/Modern_Logo_1.png`
- Keeps the brand pillars implied by the concept doc: **security, simplicity, centrality**
- Designed for implementation in marketing + product surfaces without replacing core identity

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1) Design intent: "Modern Ledger"

Positioning shift

- **Current direction:** bright SaaS utility, energetic accents
- **Alternate direction:** calm, executive-grade, structured confidence

Emotional targets

- Reliable under pressure
- Quietly premium
- Operationally precise (not flashy)

Brand sentence

> PMS is the control layer that makes complex property operations feel ordered, visible, and dependable.

2) Logo usage adaptations (compatible with existing assets)

Primary source remains: `Branding/Modern_Logo_1.png`

Allowed contexts in this alternate system

1. **Default on light neutral backgrounds** (`Canvas / Paper` tones below)
2. **Reverse treatment on dark backgrounds** only if legibility is preserved (use provided logo variant if available; if not available, place logo in a light container chip)
3. **Monochrome lockup** for print/documents where color reproduction is limited

Updated layout behavior

- Clear space: at least **1× logomark height** on all sides (same as current)
- Min size: **120 px digital / 25 mm print** (same as current)
- Prefer left alignment in product UI headers; centered only for title/cover moments

Not allowed

- Re-drawing key/house geometry
- Applying glow/gradient directly onto logo file
- Cropping into the logomark shape

3) Alternate color palette (implementation-ready)

> Strategy: keep trust navy lineage, reduce saturation, add premium neutrals and restrained highlight color.

Core tokens

- **Ink 900 (Primary text):** `#101828`
- **Ink 700 (Secondary text):** `#344054`
- **Canvas (App background):** `#F8F9FB`
- **Paper (Card background):** `#FFFFFF`
- **Line (Borders/dividers):** `#D0D5DD`

Brand accents

- **Trust Navy (Primary brand):** `#0A2540` (aligned with modern concept doc)
- **Signal Amber (Accent):** `#FFC107` (use sparingly for highlights, not body text)
- **Action Blue (Interactive):** `#1D4ED8`

Semantic colors

- **Success:** `#0F9D58`
- **Warning:** `#D97706`
- **Danger:** `#C62828`
- **Info:** `#0369A1`

Usage ratios

- 70% neutrals (Ink/Canvas/Paper/Line)
- 20% Trust Navy + Action Blue
- 10% Signal Amber + semantic statuses

Accessibility rules

- All body text combinations must meet **WCAG AA (4.5:1)** minimum
- Amber is **not** for long-form text on white; use for badges, micro-highlights, and charts only

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4) Typography pairing

> Distinct from the current all-Inter approach while still easy to ship via web fonts/system fallbacks.

Primary pairing

- **Headlines:** `Manrope` (600/700)
- **Body/UI:** `Inter` (400/500)
- **Mono/data:** `JetBrains Mono` (400/500)

Fallback stack

- `Manrope, Inter, -apple-system, Segoe UI, Roboto, Arial, sans-serif`

Type scale

- Display: 40/48, 700
- H1: 32/40, 700
- H2: 24/32, 600
- H3: 20/28, 600
- Body L: 16/24, 400
- Body M: 14/22, 400
- Label: 12/16, 500

Typographic behavior

- Tighten headline tracking slightly (-1% to -2%)
- Keep paragraph measure around 60–75 characters

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5) Component style language

Visual principles

- Structured, quiet, data-forward
- Corners: **8px base radius** (cards), **10px** (modals), **999px** (chips)
- Shadow: soft and low elevation; rely more on border + contrast than heavy drop shadows

Key components

1. **Buttons**
    - Primary: Trust Navy background, white text
    - Secondary: white background, Ink text, Line border
    - Tertiary: text-only, Action Blue
2. **Cards**
    - Paper background + 1px Line border
    - Optional left accent bar (Action Blue or semantic tone)

3. **Tables**
    - Dense but readable row spacing (44–48px row height)
    - Sticky header in Canvas tone
4. **Forms**
    - Labels always visible above fields
    - Helper text default in Ink 700
    - Error copy concise, action-oriented
5. **Status badges**
    - Subtle tinted backgrounds with dark text
    - Avoid neon fills

Spacing rhythm

- Base unit: **4px**
- Recommended sequence: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64

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6) Imagery direction

Style

- Real-world operational scenes: properties, field inspections, leasing interactions, dashboards-in-context
- Slightly desaturated color grade; avoid hyper-saturated stock look

Composition

- Favor clean architectural lines and centered perspectives
- Use shallow overlays in Trust Navy (`8–16%`) for text legibility

Avoid

- Generic handshake imagery
- Overly staged smiling office shots
- Heavy duotone effects that conflict with product visuals

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7) Iconography

System

- Use a consistent outline icon family (1.75–2px stroke)
- Rounded corners on icon paths to mirror UI softness

Behavioral rules

- Default icon color: Ink 700
- Interactive icons: Action Blue on hover/focus
- Status icons: semantic colors only for true states

Domain icon set (priority)

- Lease, Unit, Payment, Work Order, Inspection, Compliance, Tenant, Owner, Report

8) Motion tone

Personality

- Purposeful, brief, and predictable

Motion specs

- Duration: 120–220ms for micro-interactions
- Easing: `cubic-bezier(0.2, 0.8, 0.2, 1)`
- Entrance: subtle fade + 4–8px translate
- No bounce on enterprise/data screens

Priority

- Motion should guide attention, not brand decoration

9) Messaging tone (alternate)

Voice profile

- Direct, composed, evidence-led
- More “operations brief” than “startup hype”

Copy guidelines

- Lead with outcome + control
- Use concrete nouns and verbs
- Back claims with visible proof points (time saved, error reduction, occupancy impact)

Examples

- Instead of: “Reinvent property operations with AI magic.”
- Use: “Track leasing, maintenance, and payments from one operational view.”
- Instead of: “Supercharge your workflows instantly.”
- Use: “Automate routine approvals while keeping manual override where it matters.”

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10) Practical implementation notes

1. Keep existing logo binary unchanged; adapt surrounding layout/color only.
2. Introduce alternate tokens in a parallel theme file (e.g., `theme-modern-ledger`).
3. Roll out by surface:
    - Phase 1: pitch decks + case studies
    - Phase 2: marketing pages
    - Phase 3: product UI opt-in theme
4. Validate contrast and component parity before full adoption.

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11) Assumptions and source grounding

Grounded in available files

- `Branding/Modern_Logo_1.png`
- `Branding/BRAND_STYLE_GUIDE.md`
- `Branding/BRAND_QUICK_REFERENCE.md`
- `pms-plans/marketing/brand-logo-concept-modern.md`

Explicit assumptions

1. The current primary logo asset is a modern key/house concept and remains canonical.
2. No separate dark/reverse logo binaries are currently present.

3. “PMS identity compatibility” means preserving trust/security/simplicity cues and logo structure while altering expression.
4. Typography recommendations use widely available web fonts and may require product team approval before shipping.